

# Run Your Own Race

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If we believe the lies of the enemy, we will attempt to **COMPETE** with the people God has called us to **COMPLETE**.

Some people feel the need to compete in order to gain popularity, respect and success amongst their leaders, peers and even their family. I want you to know that you shouldn't be competing with anyone!

Favor on your life isn't just granted so you can earn recognition. Jesus already recognizes **WHO** you are and assigns unmerited favor to you without the need to **EARN** it through works.

I want to encourage you today to shake off the notion to perform and simply relax in the finished work of Christ.

**Performance based ministry is saturated with the spirit of legalism and does not benefit the Kingdom of God!**

I believe we all struggle with a degree of **INSECURITY** and **PERFORMANCE** based ministry because we've all had our true **IDENTITIES** distorted by the sin we were born into. God created us to be His **INTIMATE** friends, but sin separates us and makes us feel **INCOMPLETE** and **INSECURE**.

That **VOID** compels us to **COMPETE** with and **COMPARE** ourselves to one another. We end up living based on the **PERCEPTIONS** and unrealistic **EXPECTATIONS** of others, and

we let our **SIN** lead us there because it feels natural.

Today...I'm **FED UP** with seeing this need to **PERFORM** in life and ministry. Today...I want you to know that you need to **RUN YOUR OWN RACE**...not everyone else's!

How do you **RUN YOUR OWN RACE**?

## 1. KNOW YOURSELF

God has designed us to be **FRUITFUL** where He has planted us. However, we won't be fruitful if we really haven't discovered who we are and what ministry God has called us to.

**Ask yourself the following questions:**

- What are my gifts?
  - How do I see God using me now?
  - How has He used me to minister to others in the past?
  - What message does my life seem to write over and over?
- Knowing yourself starts with a **SELF-EXAMINATION** of your life, gifts and calling so that God will help you see who He has created you to be. I love Peter's explanation of this in **2 Peter 1:3** and also **James 1:5-6**.
- *By his divine power, God has given us everything we need for living a godly life. We have received all of this by coming to know him, the one who called us to himself by means of his marvelous glory and excellence.*
  - *5 If you need wisdom, ask our generous God, and he will give it to you. He will not rebuke you for asking. 6 But when you ask him, be sure that your faith is in God alone. Do not waver, for a person with divided loyalty is as unsettled as a wave of the sea that is blown and tossed by the wind.*

When He speaks to you and you understand who you are, you won't feel the pressure to become someone else. This is the first

key to running your own race!

## 2. BE YOURSELF

It's tempting to watch and analyze other people who are successful and think we have to be like them, especially in the world of Internet overload. However, doing this **FREEZES** our fruitfulness because we fall victim to **COMPARISON**, **COMPETITION** and other people's **EXPECTATIONS** and **PERCEPTIONS**!

**FREE YOURSELF** by knowing that God only expects you to be **YOU**!

If you're feeling pressure to become anyone else, then know that that impulse did not come from The Holy Spirit...but rather your old nature!

**THROW IT OFF!**

God did not **FREE** you just to make you a slave to sin again! If the Son has set you free, then you are free! (**John 8:36**)

Don't throw away your hopes and dreams...I believe God wants to use you beyond what you can imagine! He can align your hopes and dreams to His so that you're not **STRIVING**, **COMPETING** or **COMPARING** and becoming **FRUSTRATED**!

**Friend, run your own race,  
not someones else's!**

You are not equipped to run someone else's...you are only equipped to run the race that Jesus has designed for you. Only you can run in our lane, so **STAY IN IT** and don't merge into someone else's.

**KNOW YOURSELF** and **BE YOURSELF** and I believe you will  
*"win the prize for which Christ has called you heavenward in  
Christ Jesus!"* (**Philippians 4:13**)